Michael Hankinson

CONTACT INFORMATION

Department of Political Science
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INTERESTS

Political behavior, institutions, local political economy, federalism, and public policy.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

George Washington University

Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science — 2020 - Present

Princeton University, School of Public and International Affairs

Fellow, Center for the Study of Democratic Politics — 2024 - 2025

Baruch College, City University of New York

Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science — 2018 - 2020

Oberlin College

Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Politics — 2017 - 2018

EDUCATION

Harvard University

Ph.D., Government & Social Policy — 2017

- Winner of Senator Charles M. Sumner Prize
- Doctoral Fellow, Multidisciplinary Program in Inequality

University of Virginia

B.A., Government and Environmental Thought & Practice — 2010

- *High Honors*, Environmental Thought & Practice
- Echols Scholar for College of Arts and Sciences

REFEREED JOURNAL ARTICLES

11. "The Shape of Democracy: Jurisdiction Boundaries and the Siting of Renewable Energy Infrastructure" (with Carsten Andersen, Martin Vinæs Larsen, Asya Magazinnik, and Peter Bjerre Mortensen). Conditionally accepted at *American Journal of Political Science*.

10. "Reform Drift: How Incumbent Protection Undermines Descriptive Representation in Local Government" (with Joseph R. Loffredo and Asya Magazinnik). Accepted at the *American Journal of Political Science*.

9. "The Policy Adjacent: How Affordable Housing Generates Policy Feedback Among Neighboring Residents" (with Asya Magazinnik and Melissa Sands). Forthcoming at *American Journal of Political Science*.

    *awarded the *Best Paper on American Political Economy Prize*, APSA American Political Economy Section.

8. "How Self-Interest and Symbolic Politics Shape the Effectiveness of Compensation for Nearby Housing Development." *Journal of Public Policy*. 44(4): 785-808. October 2024. (with Justin de Benedictis-Kessner).

7. "When Do Local Interest Groups Participate in the Housing Entitlement Process?" *Journal of Political Institutions and Political Economy* 5(1): 47-69. September 2024. (with Asya Magazinnik and Anna Weissman).

6. "How the Identity of Substance Users Shapes Public Opinion on Opioid Treatment Policy." *Political Behavior* 46(1): 609-629. March 2024. (with Justin de Benedictis-Kessner).

    *awarded the *Lupia-Metz Outstanding Publication Award*, Time-sharing Experiments for the Social Sciences.

5. "Inaccuracies in Low Income Housing Geocodes: When and Why They Matter." *Urban Affairs Review* 60(1): 217-231. January 2024. (with Nicole E. Wilson, Asya Magazinnik, and Melissa Sands).

4. "The Supply-Equity Trade-off: The Effect of Spatial Representation on the Local Housing Supply." *The Journal of Politics* 85(3): 1033-1047. July 2023. (with Asya Magazinnik).

    *awarded the *Lawrence Longley Award for Best Article*, APSA Representation and Electoral Systems Section.

3. "Concentrated Burdens: How Self-Interest and Partisanship Shape Opinion on Opioid Treatment Policy." *American Political Science Review* 113(4): 1078-1084. November 2019. (with Justin de Benedictis-Kessner).

2. "When Do Renters Behave Like Homeowners? High Rent, Price Anxiety, and NIMBYism." *American Political Science Review* 112(3): 473-493. August 2018.

1. "Racial and Spatial Targeting: How Segregation Affected Subprime Lending and the Housing Crisis." *Social Forces* 93(3): 1081-1108. March 2015. (with Jackelyn Hwang and Kreg Steven Brown).

Working Papers

"The Voters' Veto: Local Racial Demographic Change and Exclusionary Behavior." Revised & resubmitted at *Urban Affairs Review*.

"The Resilient, but Limited Effect of Process on Fairness and Legitimacy: Evidence from Wind Energy." Under review.

"Racial Demographic Change Primes Do Not Affect Affordable Housing Attitudes Among Whites"(with Ethan Porter). Under review.

"Assessing District Elections as a Remedy in State Voting Rights Acts" (with Joseph R. Loffredo and Asya Magazinnik). Under review.

"'City Limits' of Representation: Misperceived Public Opinion and Coincidental Representation in Housing Policy" (with Adrian Pietrzak)

"The Independent Effects of Partisan Cues and Self-Interest: Evidence from Local Housing Policy Attitudes"

Other Publications

"How opioid treatment centers can overcome bipartisan NIMBYism to build local support." *The Conversation*. May 2024. (with Justin de Benedictis-Kessner).

"Inaccuracies in Low Income Housing Geocodes: When and Why They Matter." *Urban Affairs Review Blog*. April 2023. (with Nicole E. Wilson, Asya Magazinnik, and Melissa

Sands).

"Democrats are more likely to support funding opioid treatment programs compared to Republicans, but both are opposed to building clinics nearby." *LSE US Centre: American Politics and Policy.* October 2019. (with Justin de Benedictis-Kessner).

"Segregation and subprime lending within and across metropolitan areas." *Focus: Institute for Research on Poverty.* 34(4): 10-17. March 2019. (with Jackelyn Hwang and Kreg Steven Brown).

"Externalities or Extortion? Privatizing Social Policy through Community Benefits Agreements." *Harvard Journal of Real Estate.* 6-13. 2013.

Select Current Projects

"Can Side Payments Solve NIMBYism? Experimental Evidence" (with Morris Davis, Edward Glaeser, and Joseph Gyourko)

"Member Deference and the Local Housing Supply: Observational and Experimental Evidence" (with Asya Magazinnik and Adrian Pietrzak)

"The Effect of Public Comment on Housing Permitting" (with Alexander Sahn and Adrian Pietrzak)

External Grants

Coefficient Giving — *YIMBY Project Advocacy Program Evaluation.* $150,000. Co-PI (with Alexander Sahn). 2025–2027.

Arnold Ventures — *Building a National Housing Permits Database.* $62,167. Co-PI (with Asya Magazinnik and Evan Mast). 2025–2026.

Russell Sage Foundation Presidential Grant — *Aggregating Voters and the Electoral Connection: The Effect of Neighborhood Representation on the Welfare and Equity of the Housing Supply.* $48,159. Co-PI (with Asya Magazinnik). 2019–2021.

Time-sharing Experiments for the Social Sciences (TESS) — *Attribution of Responsibility and Accountability for the Opioid Crisis.* In-kind. Co-PI (with Justin de Benedictis-Kessner). 2019.

TESS Short Studies Program — *Burden Sharing and Collective Action: A Study of Opinion on Opioid Treatment Funding.* In-kind. Co-PI (with Justin de Benedictis-Kessner). 2018.

TESS — *Do Liberals and Conservatives Differ When It Comes To New Housing? A Conjoint Experiment to Measure Ideology and Land Use.* In-kind. PI. 2015.

Boston Area Research Initiative — *Who Does the City Hear?* $5,000. PI. 2017.

Boston Area Research Initiative — *Stimulating and Measuring Civic Engagement through the Introduction of Unclaimed Property in Public Spaces* $7,400. Co-PI (with Ryan Enos, Justin de Benedictis-Kessner, and Melissa Sands). 2015.

Fellowships and Internal Awards

GW University Facilitating Fund. $15,000. PI. 2023.
GWIPP Shapiro Policy Research Scholar. $11,000. PI. 2022.

PSC-CUNY Research Award. $6,000. Co-PI (with Riley Carney). 2019.
CUNY Academy for the Humanities and Sciences, Stewart Travel Award. $200. PI. 2019.
Graduate School of Design — Real Estate, Research Grant. $7,500. PI. 2017.
Harvard Horizons, Professional Development Grant. $1,000. PI. 2016.
Taubman Center for State and Local Government (Harvard Kennedy School), Urban Dissertation Fellowship. $5,000. PI. 2016–2017.
Institute for Quantitative Social Science (Harvard), Research Grant. $3,000. PI. 2016.
Joint Center for Housing Studies (Harvard), John R. Meyer Dissertation Fellowship. $5,000. PI. 2016–2017.
Foundations of Human Behavior Initiative (Harvard), Research Grant. $5,000. PI. 2015.
Joint Center for Housing Studies (Harvard), Research Grant. $10,500. PI. 2015.
CAPS (Harvard), Research Seed Grant. $1,000. PI. 2015.
Multidisciplinary Program in Inequality & Social Policy (Harvard), Research Travel Scholarship. $2,500. PI. 2013.

Honors

Clarence Stone Scholar Award, Urban and Local Politics Section, American Political Science Association, 2025
Andrew Carnegie Fellows Program, Junior Nominee, George Washington University, 2024
Lawrence Longley Award for Best Article, APSA Representation and Electoral Systems Section, 2024
Best Paper on American Political Economy, APSA American Political Economy Section, 2023
Lupia-Metz Outstanding Publication Award, Time-sharing Experiments for the Social Sciences (TESS), 2023
Susan Clarke Young Scholar Award, Urban and Local Politics Section, American Political Science Association, 2020
Senator Charles M. Sumner Prize, Department of Political Science, Harvard University, 2017

Invited Talks

2027
- GWU Trachtenberg School of Public Policy and Public Administration

2026
- Canadian Municipal Barometer Speaker Series
- University of Toronto Political Behavior Workshop
- Texas A&M University, Department of Political Science
- European University Institute: Global Challenges to Local Governance
- Johns Hopkins University: Politics of Housing Abundance and Diversity
- Institute for Humane Studies: The Political Economy of Housing Workshop
- UCLA: Climate Politics Working Group
- University of Houston, Hobby School of Public Affairs
- Johns Hopkins University, School of Government and Policy

2025
- Princeton University: The Politics of Clean Energy Abundance
- NYU Furman Center for Real Estate and Urban Policy

2024
- UC-Berkeley: Research Workshop in American Politics
- UC-Berkeley: Abundance Accelerator Initiative at the Possibility Lab
- Princeton University SPIA: CSDP Colloquium
- Aarhus University: The Politics of Housing Workshop
- Aarhus University: Research Workshop

- University of Southern California: PIPE Conference on Housing

2023
- Columbia University, School of International and Public Affairs
- UC-Berkeley: Berkeley Housing Politics and Policy Conference
- Local Political Economy Conference
- Society for Political Methodology Annual Meeting

2022
- Consortium on American Political Economy (CAPE)
- Princeton University: CSDP Conference on Housing Politics and Policy
- Princeton University: The Spatial Dimension of Economic and Political Inequality Workshop
- Columbia University, Department of Political Science

2021
- Consortium on American Political Economy (CAPE)

2020
- University of Southern California: Political Institutions and Political Economy (PIPE) Workshop
- St. Anselm College: Land-Use Regulation and Housing Affordability Research Workshop

2019
- UC-San Diego, School of Global Policy and Strategy
- George Washington University, Department of Political Science
- Emory University, Department of Political Science
- Local Political Economy Conference
- New York University, Furman Center for Real Estate & Urban Policy
- Yale Law School

2018
- Local Political Economy Conference

2017
- UC-Davis, Department of Political Science
- Baruch College, Department of Political Science
- National Housing Conference: Solutions for Housing Communications
- Harvard University Joint Center for Housing Studies

2016
- Yale University, Department of Political Science
- Harvard University, Joint Center for Housing Studies

2015
- Harvard University: Meeting on Political Geography
- Harvard University, Department of Sociology
- University of San Francisco

2013
- Harvard University, Real Estate Academic Initiative Alumni Advisory Board

2011
- Drexel University: Summer of the City

Conference Presentations

American Political Science Association, Annual Meeting: 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, Annual Meeting: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2025, 2026

European Political Science Society, Annual Meeting: 2026

Midwest Political Science Association, Annual Meeting: 2015, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2022, 2023

Urban Affairs Association, Annual Meeting: 2022

North American Meeting of the Urban Economics Association: 2021
Boston Area Research Initiative, Spring Conference: 2017

Teaching

George Washington University
Assistant Professor
- PSC 1002 - Intro. to American Government & Politics — Spring 2021, 2024, 2026
- PSC 2211 - State and Urban Politics — Fall 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2025; Spring 2024, 2026
- PSC 3192 - Infrastructure: Inaction & Inequality — Fall 2023, 2025, 2026

Baruch College, CUNY
Assistant Professor
- POL 2353 - Public Policy — Spring 2019
- POL 3005 - Social Welfare Policy — Fall 2018, 2019; Spring 2019, 2020

Oberlin College
Postdoctoral Fellow
- POLT 410 - Quantitative Analysis of Public Policy — Spring 2018
- POLT 286 - Power, Politics, and the American City — Fall 2017

Harvard College
Instructor
- Gov 94mh - Power, Politics, and the American City — Spring 2016

Teaching Fellow
- Gov 99 - Senior Writing Tutorial — Fall 2014 - Spring 2015
- Gov 1372 - Political Psychology — Spring 2013

Advising

Dissertation Committee
Completed:
- Sara Bornstein, "Parties, Institutions, and Policy Priorities: Evidence from State Education Agencies Nationwide and Local School Boards in Pennsylvania," 2025
- Dickson Su, "Policy Feedback Effects in the American States," 2023

In progress:
- Zach Broeren (Vanderbilt University), *TBD*, expected 2029
- Finn Dobkin, "Three Essays on Land-Use and Environmental Regulation," expected 2027

Senior Thesis
- Grace Truslow, 2024

Independent Research
- Lakshmi Dev, 2026-2027
- Joshua Lipman, Fall 2025, 2026

Internship-for-Credit
- Harrison Tannenbaum, Fall 2025
- David Lawrence, Spring 2024
- Ishan Lal, Fall 2023
- John Lindholm, Spring 2023
- Olivia Harris, Fall 2021
- Michael Mirsky, Spring 2021

Service

APSA Urban and Local Politics Section
- Executive Council — 2026 – 2027
- Byran Jackson Dissertation Research Award Committee — 2026

APSA Representation and Electoral Systems Section
- Lawrence Longley Award Committee — 2025, 2026

Department of Political Science, George Washington University

- Search Committee, American Politics Faculty Search 2027
- Internal Examiner, Mayuko Maeda Dissertation 2027
- Monroe Hall Floor Warden 2024 – present
- Member, American Politics Exam Committee 2024
- Diversity Advocate, American Politics Faculty Search 2021

Department of Political Science, Baruch College, CUNY

- Coordinator of the Faculty Research Workshop Committee 2019 – 2020
- Member of the Faculty Research Workshop Committee 2019 – 2020
- Faculty Senate Representative 2019 – 2020
- Recording Secretary & Blackboard Administrator 2018 – 2020
- Member of the 2019 Faculty Search Committee

Referee Service

American Political Science Review, American Journal of Political Science, American Journal of Sociology, British Journal of Political Science, Housing Policy Debate, Interest Groups & Advocacy, Journal of Experimental Political Science, Journal of Health Politics, Policy and Law, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Politics, Journal of Theoretical Politics, Perspectives on Politics, Political Behavior, Political Science Quarterly, Political Science Research and Methods, Public Opinion Quarterly, Quarterly Journal of Political Science, Regional Science & Urban Economics, Social Forces, Social Science Quarterly, Time-Sharing Experiments for the Social Sciences, Urban Affairs Review

Memberships and Affiliations

American Political Science Association, Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, Center for American Political Studies at Harvard University, National Capital Area Political Science Association, Local Politics Lab at the HKS Bloomberg Center for Cities

Languages

English (fluent), Spanish (conversational), Mandarin Chinese (elementary, HSK 3)